

AESA Website Editing Guide

A practical guide for editing, adding images, and making the current AESA React/Vite website more dynamic.

Project: Sarujan2001/AESA

Live domain: <https://aesa.site>

App folder: my-app

1. How This Website Works

Your site is a React app built with Vite. GitHub Actions builds it and publishes the generated files to GitHub Pages.

File or folder	What it controls
<code>my-app/src/App.jsx</code>	Main website content, pages, navigation, team, calendar, sponsors, contact form behavior, and image URLs.
<code>my-app/src/index.css</code>	All visual styling: layout, colors, spacing, mobile responsiveness, buttons, cards, and typography.
<code>my-app/src/main.jsx</code>	Mounts the React app. You usually do not need to edit this.
<code>my-app/public/</code>	Files copied directly into the final website, such as <code>CNAME</code> , icons, and public images.
<code>my-app/vite.config.js</code>	Build settings. For <code>aesa.site</code> , <code>base: '/'</code> is correct.
<code>.github/workflows/deploy.yml</code>	GitHub Pages deployment workflow. You usually do not edit this now that deployment works.

Important: Because the custom domain is `aesa.site`, keep this in `vite.config.js`:

```
base: '/',
```

Only use `base: '/AESA/'` if you go back to `https://sarujan2001.github.io/AESA/`.

2. The Fast Editing Workflow

1. Open the project in VS Code.
2. Edit the content in `my-app/src/App.jsx`.
3. Edit the design in `my-app/src/index.css`.
4. Test locally with `npm.cmd run dev` from inside `my-app`.
5. Build-test with `npm.cmd run build`.
6. Commit and push:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Update website content"
git push origin main
```

7. GitHub Actions redeploys the live website automatically.

3. Where To Edit Common Content

Club name, email, address, and social links

In `App.jsx`, edit the `club` object near the top:

```
const club = {
  name: "Aerospace Engineering Student Association",
  shortName: "AESA",
  email: "rmitaesa@gmail.com",
  location: "124 La Trobe St, Melbourne VIC 3000",
  socials: {
    facebook: "https://www.facebook.com/RMIT.AESA/",
    instagram: "https://www.instagram.com/rmitaesa/",
    linkedin: "https://au.linkedin.com/company/rmit-aerospace-engineering-student-association-aesa",
    rubric: "https://campus.hellorubric.com/?s=957",
    linktree: "https://linktr.ee/rmitaesa",
  },
};
```

Navigation menu

Edit `navItems`. The first value is the label users see. The second value is the page or section target.

```
const navItems = [
  ["Home", "home"],
  ["Activities", "activities"],
  ["Calendar", "#calendar"],
  ["Team", "team"],
  ["Past Events", "past"],
  ["Join Us", "join"],
  ["Contact", "#contact"],
];
```

Hero focus tags

Edit the `focusAreas` array:

```
const focusAreas = ["Aerodynamics", "Structures", "Propulsion", "UAVs", "Space systems", "Simulation"];
```

4. Editing Events, Team, Sponsors, and Past Events

Calendar events

Edit the `calendar` array. Each row is:

```
["Date", "Title", "Location", "Time", "Price"]
```

Example:

```
const calendar = [  
  ["May 7", "Aerospace Industry Night 2026", "Storey Hall, Building 16", "6:30 PM - 9:30 PM",  
  "Free"],  
  ["TBA", "Campus Fest / Club Day", "Bowen Street, RMIT City Campus", "Daytime", "Free"],  
];
```

Activities

Edit the `activities` array. Each row is:

```
["Activity title", "Small tag", "Description"]
```

Team members

Edit `executiveTeam` and `generalCommittee`. Each row is:

```
["Name", "Role", "Short description", "Image path or image URL"]
```

Sponsors

Edit `sponsors`. Each row is:

```
["Fallback initials", "Sponsor name", "Sponsor website", "Logo path or logo URL"]
```

Past events

Edit `pastEvents`. Each event uses an object:

```
{  
  title: "Aerospace Industry Night 2026",  
  year: "2026",  
  text: "Short event summary.",  
  image: "/images/ain-2026.jpg",  
}
```

5. Adding Your Own Pictures Instead Of Links

You currently use image URLs from services like Unsplash and Clearbit. For your own images, the simplest reliable method is to put image files in `my-app/public/images/`.

Step-by-step

1. Create a folder: `my-app/public/images`.
2. Put your image there, for example `sarujan.jpg`.
3. Use this path in `App.jsx`:

```
"/images/sarujan.jpg"
```

Example: Replace a team photo

Before:

```
["Sarujan Srikanan", "Careers Director", "Public description",  
"https://images.unsplash.com/photo-example"]
```

After:

```
["Sarujan Srikanan", "Careers Director", "Public description", "/images/sarujan.jpg"]
```

Example: Replace a sponsor logo

Put the logo file here:

```
my-app/public/images/qantas-logo.png
```

Then update the sponsor row:

```
["QF", "Qantas", "https://www.qantas.com/", "/images/qantas-logo.png"]
```

Recommended image sizes

Use	Recommended size	Format
Team photos	800 x 600 or larger, landscape crop	<code>.jpg</code> or <code>.webp</code>
Past event photos	1200 x 800 or larger	<code>.jpg</code> or <code>.webp</code>
Sponsor logos	Transparent logo if possible, around 600 px wide	<code>.png</code> , <code>.svg</code> , or <code>.webp</code>
Icons	Square, 512 x 512	<code>.png</code> or <code>.svg</code>

Tip: File names should avoid spaces. Use `aerospace-night-2026.jpg` instead of `Aerospace Night 2026.jpg`.

6. Making The Site More Dynamic

Right now, the website is static React: content is stored directly inside `App.jsx`. That is okay for a small club site, but it means every content update requires editing code and pushing to GitHub.

Level 1: Keep it simple, but cleaner

Move the data arrays into a separate file like `my-app/src/data/siteData.js`. This makes the website easier to edit without scrolling through the component code.

Create:

```
my-app/src/data/siteData.js
```

Example:

```
export const calendar = [
  ["May 7", "Aerospace Industry Night 2026", "Storey Hall, Building 16", "6:30 PM - 9:30 PM",
  "Free"],
];
```

Then in `App.jsx`:

```
import { calendar } from "../data/siteData.js";
```

This is the best first improvement for your current website.

Level 2: Use JSON content files

You can store content in JSON files such as:

```
my-app/src/data/calendar.json
my-app/src/data/team.json
my-app/src/data/sponsors.json
```

Then import them:

```
import calendar from "../data/calendar.json";
```

This is still static, but it separates content from React code and is easier for non-developers to edit carefully.

Level 3: Use a CMS or database

If you want committee members to edit events and photos from a dashboard, use a hosted CMS such as Sanity, Contentful, Decap CMS, or Supabase. The website would fetch content from that service.

This is more powerful, but it adds accounts, API keys, permissions, and extra maintenance.

Approach	Best for	Complexity
Current <code>App.jsx</code> arrays	Small site, one editor	Low
<code>siteData.js</code>	Cleaner code, still simple	Low
JSON files	Structured content editing	Medium
CMS/database	Multiple editors, live dashboard	High

7. Recommended Refactor For This Website

If you want the site to feel dynamic while keeping GitHub Pages, use `siteData.js`. GitHub Pages cannot run a backend server, but React can still render dynamic-looking pages from structured data.

Suggested structure:

```
my-app/src/data/siteData.js
my-app/public/images/team/
my-app/public/images/events/
my-app/public/images/sponsors/
```

Move these values out of `App.jsx`:

- `club`
- `navItems`
- `focusAreas`
- `sponsors`
- `activities`
- `calendar`
- `executiveTeam`
- `generalCommittee`
- `pastEvents`
- `benefits`

Then import them at the top of `App.jsx`:

```
import {
  club,
  navItems,
  focusAreas,
  sponsors,
  activities,
```

```
calendar,  
executiveTeam,  
generalCommittee,  
pastEvents,  
benefits,  
} from "../data/siteData.js";
```

8. Editing The Design

Most styling lives in `my-app/src/index.css`.

Change brand colors

Edit the CSS variables at the top:

```
:root {  
  --paper: #f5f1e8;  
  --ink: #111318;  
  --muted: #5f6670;  
  --line: #d8d1c4;  
  --red: #d71920;  
  --charcoal: #171a21;  
  --white: #ffffff;  
}
```

For example, changing `--red` changes many highlight elements across the website.

Change mobile layout

Responsive rules are near the bottom of `index.css` inside:

```
@media (max-width: 1040px) { ... }  
@media (max-width: 680px) { ... }
```

Change sponsor logo display

Look for:

```
.sponsor-logo {  
  width: 96px;  
  height: 72px;  
  object-fit: contain;  
}
```

9. Testing Before Publishing

From the project root:

```
cd my-app  
npm.cmd run dev
```

Open the local URL that Vite prints, usually `http://localhost:5173/`.

Before pushing, run:

```
npm.cmd run build
```

If this passes, GitHub Actions is much more likely to pass too.

10. Publishing Changes

After edits:

```
git status
git add .
git commit -m "Update AESA website"
git push origin main
```

Then check GitHub Actions:

```
https://github.com/Sarujan2001/AESA/actions
```

When the workflow is green, check the live site:

```
https://aesa.site
```

11. Common Problems

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
404 on <code>aesa.site</code>	DNS or GitHub Pages custom domain not ready	Check DNS A records, CNAME file, GitHub Pages settings, and wait for propagation.
Images do not show	Wrong path or file name	Use paths like <code>/images/team/sarujan.jpg</code> and check capitalization.
Build fails on GitHub	Local build would also fail	Run <code>npm.cmd run build</code> locally and fix the first error.
Site works locally but not live	Changes not pushed or deployment not finished	Run <code>git push origin main</code> and check Actions.
Custom domain disappears after deploy	No <code>CNAME</code> in build output	Keep <code>my-app/public/CNAME</code> with <code>aesa.site</code> .

12. Best Next Step

The best improvement for this website is to create `my-app/src/data/siteData.js` and move all editable content there. That makes future updates easier, keeps the design code separate, and still works perfectly on GitHub Pages.

After that, add your real images into:

```
my-app/public/images/team/  
my-app/public/images/events/  
my-app/public/images/sponsors/
```

Then replace external image URLs in `App.jsx` or `siteData.js` with local paths like `/images/team/name.jpg`.